CLC STRIDERS RUNNING CLUB

GRIEVANCE AND DISCIPLINARY POLICY

The Club is committed to providing an environment free from abuse, harassment, discrimination, bullying and defamation. Such behaviour will not be tolerated during or following any Club activity, including races, training sessions, meetings and social events.

Disciplinary Action

Any Member may be subject to disciplinary action, including suspension or termination of membership, where their conduct is, or is likely to be, detrimental to the interests, reputation or wellbeing of the Club.

A decision to suspend or terminate membership must be approved by a minimum two-thirds majority of those present and voting at a properly convened Committee meeting, provided that at least five voting Committee members are present.

The Member concerned will be given not less than one month's written notice of the meeting, together with full details of the allegations or concerns to be considered.

The Member shall have the right to attend the meeting and present their case but shall not be present during deliberations or voting, except where permitted by the Committee. Any Committee member who is the subject of the proceedings shall not participate in the decision-making process or vote.

Appeals

Any Member subject to disciplinary action may appeal the decision by submitting a written appeal to the Committee.

Where appropriate, the Member may request that the matter be referred to a panel of three arbitrators:

- one appointed by the Committee;
- one appointed and funded by the Member; and
- a third jointly appointed by the first two arbitrators.

If the first two arbitrators cannot agree on the appointment of a third arbitrator, the appointment shall be made by the South of England Athletics Association (SEAA), or another appropriate body nominated by the Committee.

The arbitrators shall have the authority to uphold, vary or overturn the disciplinary sanction and may impose such conditions as they consider appropriate.

Welfare and Safeguarding

All concerns, allegations or reports relating to the welfare of a child, young person or adult at risk will be recorded and managed promptly in accordance with the Club's safeguarding policies and the requirements of England Athletics.

The Welfare Officer shall act as the Club's lead officer for safeguarding matters and will provide guidance and support to members where safeguarding concerns arise.

Misconduct Complaints

Complaints regarding the conduct of any Member or Officer must be submitted in writing to the Club Secretary.

Where a complaint relates to the Secretary, it should be submitted to the Welfare Officer, who will assume responsibility for managing the process.

Complaint and Disciplinary Process

Unless exceptional circumstances apply, complaints will be reviewed within 14 days of receipt. Where sufficient evidence exists to warrant further investigation, the Secretary (or Welfare Officer, where appropriate) will appoint a Disciplinary Panel comprising three impartial Club members who have no actual or perceived conflict of interest in the matter.

The Panel will investigate the complaint, consider all relevant evidence and determine whether disciplinary action is appropriate.

The outcome will be communicated in writing to the parties concerned.

Any appeal against the Panel's decision must be submitted in writing within seven days of receipt of the written outcome. Appeals will be considered in accordance with the Club's appeals procedure.

Serious Misconduct

Allegations of serious misconduct shall be referred to England Athletics and managed in accordance with the England Athletics Disciplinary Procedures.

Serious misconduct includes, but is not limited to:

- theft or fraud;
- doping violations;
- physical violence;
- safeguarding breaches;
- serious breaches of health and safety requirements;
- gambling or ticketing offences; or
- any conduct that brings, or is likely to bring, the sport of athletics or the Club into disrepute.

Dispute Resolution

Where a dispute arises between Members or Officers concerning the interpretation, validity or application of these Rules, the parties shall seek to resolve the matter informally in the first instance.

If the dispute cannot be resolved through discussion, the parties agree to attempt mediation in good faith before commencing legal proceedings.

Related policies and procedures

- Club Constitution
- Safeguarding Policy
- Codes of Conduct
- Club Grievance and Disciplinary Policy
- Club Inclusion Policy
- Club Social Media Policy

Useful contact

- Matt Ashman – Club Secretary (secretary@clcstriders-runningclub.co.uk)

Updated and approved by the CLC Striders Chair – 8 November 2026